

THE MOST COMMON GUIDELINES REGARDING A PRESENTATION STRUCTURE

- **Ensure that the slides look good.** This does not necessarily mean that they look flashy - although suitable pictures or illustrations are very effective - but it does mean using a consistent format and **typeface** and readable colors.
- The **first slide should announce the title of your presentation**, the event and date, and your name and position. This may seem terribly obvious, but many speakers miss off some of this basic information and then weeks later listeners (or their colleagues back at the organization) are not clear who made the presentation or when. You should try to make the title catchy, so that you immediately have the interest of your audience. A challenging question works well - for instance, a presentation on the global economic crisis might ask: *"Is this the end of capitalism as we've known it?"* Or a play on words works too - for example, a presentation on next generation broadband could be titled *"The Slow Arrival of Fast Broadband"*.
- The **second slide should seize the attention of your audience** for your presentation. It could be the central proposition of your presentation or a conventional wisdom that you wish to challenge or a **relevant** or **witty** quote from a leader in your field. If it is amusing or controversial or both, so much the better.
- The **third slide should set out the structure of your presentation**. The default structure should consist of three themes that you intend to examine.
- **Each theme should be the subject of a small number of slides.**
- **Each slide should have a clear heading.** A question is often a good way of winning attention - but, in that case, make sure you answer the question in the body of the slide.
- **Each slide should normally contain around 25-35 words**, unless it is a quote (then you might use more) or contains an illustration (then you will probably use less). Too many words and your audience will have trouble reading the material.
- **Each bullet point should consist of an intelligible phrase**, rather than merely a word or two that is meaningless on its own or **conversely** a complete sentence that is better delivered orally. So, for instance, do use *"Focus on profitable and growing markets"* rather than simply *"Focus"* or *"Markets"* or *"It is necessary to focus on those markets which are profitable and growing rather than those which are loss-making and declining"*. Consider this test: your slides should make sense and be useful to someone who was not present at your presentation.
- **Make appropriate use of pictures.** It's a good idea to break up text with illustrations and it is true that a picture is worth a thousand words.
- **The last slide should set out all appropriate contact details**